TECHNICAL SUPPORT

Troubleshooting Your PC

Gaming computers contain several interconnected hardware and software components. Problems may occur because of incorrect settings, outdated drivers, incompatible components, overheating, or hardware failures.

This guide explains common troubleshooting procedures that customers can safely perform before contacting PixelForge technical support. The instructions apply primarily to Windows-based gaming PCs, although some recommendations are relevant to other systems.

Before You Begin Troubleshooting

Before making changes, customers should identify the symptoms and determine when the problem first appeared. Useful information includes whether the problem started after a hardware upgrade, software installation, operating system update, or unexpected shutdown.

Customers should save important files and create backups whenever possible before performing troubleshooting that could affect stored information.

Always shut down the computer and disconnect its power cable before inspecting internal components. Never open a power supply or attempt repairs involving exposed electrical circuitry.

If a computer produces smoke, sparks, a burning smell, or unusual electrical noises, stop using it immediately, disconnect power if safe, and contact support.

Computer Does Not Turn On

If the computer shows no signs of power, begin by checking the wall outlet, power cable, and power supply switch.

Confirm that the power cable is securely connected to the computer and that the electrical outlet works with another suitable device.

Many desktop power supplies include a physical switch marked I and O. The switch must be in the I position for normal operation.

If the computer is connected through a power strip, try connecting it directly to a functioning wall outlet.

If these checks do not resolve the problem, contact support rather than attempting to open or repair the power supply.

Computer Turns On but Shows No Display

A computer may power on while the monitor remains black. This can happen because of an incorrect display connection, monitor settings, graphics card problems, or memory initialization issues.

First, verify that the monitor is powered on and that the correct input source is selected.

Check that the HDMI or DisplayPort cable is securely connected at both ends. If the computer has a dedicated graphics card, the monitor should normally be connected to the graphics card rather than the motherboard's display outputs.

Customers may also try another compatible cable or monitor input to rule out a connection problem.

Some motherboards display diagnostic lights or error codes during startup. Customers should record these indicators and consult the motherboard manual before contacting support.

Windows Fails to Start

If the computer powers on but Windows does not load correctly, the issue may involve corrupted system files, an unsuccessful update, storage problems, or incompatible software.

Customers should record any error messages and note whether Windows displays a recovery screen.

Windows Recovery Environment may provide startup repair and other recovery options. Customers should follow Microsoft's official instructions when using these tools.

Reinstalling Windows can remove applications and may erase personal files depending on the installation method. Customers should not perform a full reset without understanding the consequences and securing important data.

Unexpected Crashes and Blue Screens

Blue screen errors, sudden restarts, and application crashes may result from driver conflicts, unstable memory settings, overheating, or defective hardware.

Customers should record the error message or stop code shown on the screen. This information can help identify the affected component or software.

If the problem began after a driver update, reverting to a previously working driver may help.

Customers using memory overclocking profiles such as XMP or EXPO may temporarily return the memory to default settings to determine whether the system becomes stable.

BIOS settings should only be changed when the customer understands their purpose. Incorrect settings can prevent a computer from starting normally.

Overheating and High Fan Noise

Gaming PCs generate heat during demanding applications. Cooling fans may become louder when the processor or graphics card is under heavy load.

However, unusually high temperatures, repeated shutdowns, or severe performance reductions may indicate a cooling problem.

Customers should ensure that ventilation openings are not blocked and that the computer has sufficient space around its intake and exhaust fans.

Dust accumulation can restrict airflow. External vents and accessible dust filters may be cleaned carefully according to the manufacturer's instructions.

Customers should not use liquids inside the computer or interfere with moving fans while the system is powered on.

If overheating continues despite adequate airflow, contact support for further assessment.

Low Gaming Performance

Poor gaming performance may be caused by demanding graphics settings, background applications, insufficient memory, outdated drivers, or hardware limitations.

Customers should compare the game's recommended system requirements with their computer specifications.

Lowering graphics settings or display resolution may improve performance in demanding games.

Background applications, downloads, and operating system updates can consume system resources. Customers can use Windows Task Manager to identify unusually high processor, memory, or disk usage.

Graphics driver updates may improve compatibility with newer games, but performance improvements vary between applications and hardware configurations.

Internet and Network Problems

Connection problems may affect multiplayer games, downloads, and online services.

Customers should first determine whether the problem affects only one application or the entire internet connection.

Restarting the router and computer may resolve temporary network problems. Customers should also verify that Wi-Fi or Ethernet connections are active.

For wireless connections, signal strength, interference, and distance from the router may influence stability.

If the problem affects multiple devices, customers may need to contact their internet service provider.

When to Contact PixelForge Support

Customers should contact support when safe troubleshooting does not resolve the problem, when a hardware defect is suspected, or when the computer displays signs of electrical damage.

Support requests should include the order number, computer model, a description of the symptoms, and any relevant error messages.

Customers should also explain which troubleshooting steps have already been attempted.

For driver installation and operating system guidance, see Driver & Software Support. For possible hardware defects and warranty coverage, consult Warranty Policy.